

Satellite radio. This provider boasts of channels in most Indian regional languages, apart from national and international news channels in English and Hindi.

While commercial radio broadcasts were taking over the world, the inherent simplicity of radio transmitting technology and the need for an open non-centralised communication system gave rise to a culture of amateur radio operations. Often transmitted from home built transmitters, this community forms an undeniably important part of the modern radio scene and will be the subject of our next discussion.

In keeping with the entertainment aspect of radio, satellite services such as WorldSpace bring numerous music channels to your room

3.3 Amateur (HAM) radio

Spanning six million people today, the amateur radio community is at the forefront of further developments in wireless communication technology. Using different bands of frequencies and techniques of modulation, amateur radio operators often use home built equipment for their purposes. These operators, more popularly known as hams, enjoy free communications, sometimes extending around the globe among themselves. The origin of the term ham is attributed to many different events, none of which can be supported with certainty.

The history of amateur radio is long and illustrious. Its origins can be found in the origins of radio itself with its pioneers being the various inventors and scientists who contributed to the development of radio. While a large amount of credit goes to Marconi, Edison, etc., credit is also due to lesser known pioneers such as Reginald Fessenden, Amos Dolbear and others.

The radio spectrum was largely unregulated and open to amateur hobbyists until 1912, when the sinking of the RMS Titanic changed everything. The Radio Regulatory act of 1912 in the USA allotted various spectra to various purposes, made ship to shore communication radios mandatory on all ships, and made it necessary to man them 24 hours. This act placed a lot of restrictions on the bandwidths and frequencies available for